

Word family: **performance / perform / performer / performing / high-performing / underperform / underperformance**

Base word: performance

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

* **performance** (n.) — 表現；績效；演出；履行；性能

* **perform** (v.) — 表現；執行；演出；運作

* **performer** (n.) — 表演者；演藝人員

* **performing** (adj./participle) — 表演中的；表現……的

* **high-performing** (adj.) — 高績效的；表現優秀的

* **underperform** (v.) — 表現低於預期

* **underperformance** (n.) — 表現欠佳；績效低於預期

* **outperform** (v.) — 表現勝過

* **performance-related** (adj.) — 與表現 / 績效掛鈎的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **job performance**

* **employee performance**

* **academic performance**

* **team performance**

* **individual performance**

* **performance review**

* **performance appraisal**

* **performance evaluation**

* **high performance**

* **poor performance**

* **performance target**

* **performance indicator**

* **performance-related pay**

* **business performance**

* **financial performance**

* **sports performance**

* **live performance**

* **give a performance**

* **performance of duties**

* **system performance**

* **engine performance**

* **high-performance computer**

* **outperform competitors**

* **underperform expectations**

Meaning in this passage

> When diligent workers realise that their **performance** is being tied to colleagues who are less committed, motivation begins to decline.

Here, **performance** means:

how well someone does their work and achieves expected results — 工作表現；績效

The diligent workers worry that their own results or evaluation will depend partly on colleagues who contribute less.

中文翻譯：

當勤奮的員工意識到自己的**工作表現 / 績效**竟然與投入程度較低的同事掛鉤時，他們的動力便開始下降。

So here:

performance = 一個人完成工作時的質素、效率、成果和達標程度

1. **performance (工作表現；績效) — 工作表現；績效**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Their **performance** was tied to the rest of the team.

他們的**工作表現 / 績效**與其他組員掛鉤。

Practice 2

> Her **performance at work** has improved significantly.

她的**工作表現**明顯改善了。

Practice 3

> Managers regularly evaluate employee **performance**.

管理人員會定期評估員工的**工作績效**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance = 某人在工作、任務或活動中做得有多好，以及取得甚麼成果****

2. ****job / employee performance — 工作 / 員工績效****

Practice 1

> Clear goals can improve ****employee performance****.

清晰目標可以改善****員工績效****。

Practice 2

> Stress may affect ****job performance****.

壓力可能影響****工作表現****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****job/employee performance = 員工完成職責、達成目標和維持工作質素的程度****

3. ****individual performance — 個人表現****

Very relevant to the teamwork paragraph.

Practice 1

> Individual ****performance**** should be evaluated fairly.

****個人表現****應受到公平評估。

Practice 2

> Group grades can sometimes hide differences in ****individual performance****.

小組成績有時會掩蓋成員之間****個人表現****的差異。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****individual performance = 某一個人本身的工作成果和表現，而不是整個團隊的結果****

4. ****team performance — 團隊表現****

Practice 1

> Poor communication can damage **team performance**.

溝通不良會損害**團隊表現**。

Practice 2

> Strong leadership improved the team's **performance**.

良好領導提升了團隊的**整體表現**。

MCQ-ready definition:

team performance = 整個團隊共同完成工作和達成目標的程度

5. **academic performance** — 學業表現

Practice 1

> Lack of sleep can affect **academic performance**.

睡眠不足可能影響**學業表現**。

Practice 2

> Her **academic performance** improved after she changed her study habits.

她改變學習習慣後，**學業表現**有所改善。

MCQ-ready definition:

academic performance = 學生在學習、作業、考試等方面的整體表現

6. **high / strong performance** — 優秀 / 強勁表現

Practice 1

> The team delivered a **strong performance**.

團隊有**出色表現**。

Practice 2

> Employees are rewarded for **high performance**.

員工會因**高績效**而獲獎勵。

MCQ-ready definition:

high/strong performance = 明顯達到或超越要求的優秀表現

7. **poor / weak performance — 表現欠佳**

Practice 1

> Poor **performance** can result from unclear expectations.

表現欠佳可能源於期望不清晰。

Practice 2

> The manager discussed his **poor performance** with him.

經理和他討論了他的**工作表現欠佳**問題。

MCQ-ready definition:

poor performance = 未能達到合理要求或預期的表現

8. **performance review — 績效評核；工作表現檢討**

Practice 1

> I have my annual **performance review** next week.

我下星期要進行年度**工作表現評核**。

Practice 2

> The manager discussed her goals during the **performance review**.

經理在**績效評核**期間和她討論了工作目標。

MCQ-ready definition:

performance review = 僱主正式檢討員工工作表現、目標和發展的過程

9. **performance appraisal / evaluation — 績效評估**

Practice 1

> Each employee receives a yearly **performance appraisal**.

每名員工每年都會接受一次**績效評估**。

Practice 2

> Individual contribution should be considered in **performance evaluation**.

進行**績效評估**時應考慮個人貢獻。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance appraisal/evaluation = 正式評估某人的工作表現和成果****

10. **performance target — 績效目標**

Practice 1

> The team met all its **performance targets**.

團隊達成了所有**績效目標**。

Practice 2

> Unrealistic **performance targets** can increase stress.

不切實際的**績效目標**可能增加壓力。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance target = 用來衡量表現的具體預期成果或標準****

11. **performance indicator — 績效指標**

Practice 1

> Customer satisfaction is an important **performance indicator**.

顧客滿意度是一項重要的**績效指標**。

Practice 2

> Managers monitor several **performance indicators**.

管理人員會監察多項**績效指標**。

MCQ-ready definition:

performance indicator = 用來量度某人、團隊或機構表現的指標

12. **performance-related pay — 績效掛鈎薪酬**

Practice 1

> Some companies use **performance-related pay**.

有些公司採用**績效掛鈎薪酬**。

Practice 2

> Bonuses may form part of **performance-related pay**.

獎金可能屬於**與工作表現掛鈎的薪酬**。

MCQ-ready definition:

performance-related pay = 薪酬或獎金部分取決於工作表現的制度

13. **performance (比賽 / 運動表現) — 運動表現；競技表現**

Practice 1

> The athlete gave an excellent **performance**.

運動員有非常出色的**表現**。

Practice 2

> Tiredness affected his **performance** in the match.

疲勞影響了他在比賽中的**表現**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance = 運動員或參賽者在比賽中發揮得有多好****

14. ****performance (演出 ; 表演) — 演出 ; 表演****

A major genuinely distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> We watched a live ****performance****.

我們觀看了一場現場****演出****。

Practice 2

> The evening ****performance**** starts at eight.

晚間****演出****八時開始。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance = 音樂、戲劇、舞蹈等正式呈現給觀眾觀看的演出****

15. ****give a performance — 演出 ; 表演****

Practice 1

> The students ****gave a performance**** at the end of the term.

學生在學期末進行了一場****表演****。

Practice 2

> The band ****gave an energetic performance****.

樂隊帶來了一場充滿活力的****演出****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****give a performance = 正式為觀眾進行音樂、戲劇、舞蹈等表演****

16. ****live performance — 現場演出****

Practice 1

> Recorded music feels different from a **live performance**.

錄音音樂和**現場演出**的感覺不同。

Practice 2

> The theatre hosts **live performances** every weekend.

劇院每個週末都有**現場表演**。

MCQ-ready definition:

live performance = 表演者即場為觀眾進行的演出，而不是預先錄製的

17. **performance** (演員 / 表演者的演技) — 演技；表演表現

Practice 1

> Her **performance** in the film was excellent.

她在電影中的**演技 / 表演**非常出色。

Practice 2

> The actor received praise for his **performance**.

演員因自己的**演出表現**而獲得讚賞。

MCQ-ready definition:

performance = 演員或表演者在某項作品中的實際表演質素

18. **perform** (執行；完成) — 執行；進行

A major verb sense.

Practice 1

> Employees must **perform their duties** properly.

員工必須妥善**履行職責**。

Practice 2

> The team **performed the task** efficiently.

團隊有效率地**執行了任務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

perform a task/duty = 執行或完成某項工作、職責或程序

19. **performance of duties — 履行職責**

A formal noun sense.

Practice 1

> Employees are responsible for the proper **performance of their duties**.

員工有責任妥善**履行自己的職責**。

Practice 2

> The illness affected the **performance of his duties**.

疾病影響了他**履行職務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

performance of duties = 正式執行和履行自己應做的職責

20. **performance (法律 / 合約 : 履行) — 履行**

A formal legal/business sense.

Practice 1

> The contract requires full **performance of the agreement**.

合約要求全面**履行協議**。

Practice 2

> Failure of **performance** may lead to legal action.

未能**履行合約義務**可能引致法律行動。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance = formal/legal: 履行合約、承諾或法律義務的行為****

21. ****specific performance — 強制履行****

A legal term.

Practice 1

> The court may order ****specific performance**** of the contract.

法院可能命令****強制履行合約****。

Practice 2

> Specific performance requires a party to carry out its contractual obligation.

****強制履行****要求一方實際完成其合約義務。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****specific performance = 法院命令當事人真正履行合約義務，而不是只支付賠償****

This is specialist legal vocabulary, useful mainly for recognition.

22. ****performance (機器 / 系統性能) — 性能；效能****

A major technical sense.

Practice 1

> The update improved computer ****performance****.

更新提升了電腦的****性能****。

Practice 2

> Engineers tested the engine's ****performance****.

工程師測試了引擎的****性能****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****performance = 機器、系統或產品運作得有多快、多可靠或多有效****

23. ****system / computer performance — 系統 / 電腦性能****

Practice 1

> Too many background programs can reduce ****system performance****.

太多背景程式可能降低****系統性能****。

Practice 2

> The new processor improves computer ****performance****.

新處理器提升了電腦的****效能****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****system performance = 系統在速度、容量、反應等方面的運作水平****

24. ****engine / vehicle performance — 引擎 / 車輛性能****

Practice 1

> The design improves ****engine performance****.

這個設計提升了****引擎性能****。

Practice 2

> Fuel quality can affect vehicle ****performance****.

燃油品質可能影響車輛****性能****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****engine/vehicle performance = 引擎或車輛在動力、速度、反應等方面的表現****

25. ****high-performance — 高性能的；高效能的****

Practice 1

> The laboratory uses **high-performance computers**.

實驗室使用**高性能電腦**。

Practice 2

> The car has a **high-performance engine**.

這輛車配備**高性能引擎**。

MCQ-ready definition:

high-performance = 能以非常高水平運作或完成工作的

26. **performance** (企業 / 財務表現) — 業績 ; 營運表現

Practice 1

> The company reported strong **performance** this year.

公司今年錄得強勁的**業績表現**。

Practice 2

> Management is concerned about weak business **performance**.

管理層擔心企業**營運表現**欠佳。

MCQ-ready definition:

business performance = 公司在收入、增長、效率、盈利等方面的整體成果

27. **financial performance** — 財務表現 ; 財務業績

Practice 1

> The report reviews the company's **financial performance**.

報告檢視公司的**財務表現**。

Practice 2

> Sales growth improved overall **financial performance**.

銷售增長改善了整體**財務業績**。

MCQ-ready definition:

financial performance = 公司在收入、成本、盈利等財務指標上的表現

28. **market performance** — 市場表現

Practice 1

> The product's **market performance** exceeded expectations.

產品的**市場表現**超出預期。

Practice 2

> Analysts compared the **performance** of different investments.

分析員比較了不同投資的**市場表現**。

MCQ-ready definition:

market performance = 產品、公司或投資在市場上的實際成果

29. **perform well / badly** — 表現好 / 差

Practice 1

> The team **performed well** under pressure.

團隊在壓力下**表現良好**。

Practice 2

> The new system **performed badly** during testing.

新系統在測試期間**表現欠佳**。

MCQ-ready definition:

perform well/badly = 在工作、活動、比賽或運作中達到好 / 差的結果

30. **performer (表演者) — 表演者 ; 演藝人員**

Practice 1

> The **performers** came onto the stage.

表演者走上舞台。

Practice 2

> She is a talented **performer**.

她是一名很有才華的**表演者**。

MCQ-ready definition:

performer = 為觀眾唱歌、跳舞、演戲或進行其他表演的人

31. **performer (表現者) — 表現.....的人 / 事物**

A wider figurative use.

Practice 1

> She is one of the team's top **performers**.

她是團隊中表現最好的**成員之一**。

Practice 2

> This investment has been a strong **performer**.

這項投資一直是**表現強勁的項目**。

MCQ-ready definition:

performer = 在某方面取得某種水平成果的人、公司、投資或產品

32. **top performer / high performer — 高績效者 ; 表現優秀的人**

Your passage actually later uses **high performers**.

Practice 1

> High **performers** may become frustrated by unfair group work.

高績效員工可能因不公平的團隊合作而感到沮喪。

Practice 2

> She is consistently a **top performer**.

她一直都是一名**表現頂尖的員工**。

MCQ-ready definition:

top/high performer = 工作或競爭表現長期優於大多數人的人

33. **high-performing team** — 高績效團隊

Practice 1

> Trust is essential in a **high-performing team**.

信任對**高績效團隊**來說不可或缺。

Practice 2

> High-performing teams combine skill with strong communication.

高績效團隊會把能力和良好溝通結合起來。

MCQ-ready definition:

high-performing team = 長期能夠達到優秀成果和高標準的團隊

34. **underperform** — 表現低於預期

Practice 1

> The team **underperformed** because of poor communication.

團隊因溝通不良而**表現低於預期**。

Practice 2

> The investment has **underperformed** this year.

這項投資今年**表現遜於預期**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****underperform = 表現低於預期、標準或比較對象****

35. ****underperformance — 表現欠佳；績效低落****

Practice 1

> Managers investigated the causes of ****underperformance****.

管理人員調查了****績效欠佳****的原因。

Practice 2

> Persistent ****underperformance**** may require additional support.

持續****表現低於標準****可能需要額外支援。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****underperformance = 長期或明顯未能達到預期表現的狀態****

36. ****outperform — 表現勝過；優於****

Practice 1

> The smaller team ****outperformed**** its competitors.

較小的團隊****表現勝過競爭對手****。

Practice 2

> The new system ****outperformed**** the old one.

新系統的****表現優於****舊系統。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****outperform X = 在表現或成果方面優於 X****

Important distinction 1: **performance vs effort**

This is central to your paragraph.

effort

input: how much work and energy someone puts in.

performance

output/quality: how well they actually do.

Someone can show:

- * high effort + weak performance
- * low effort + strong performance

So they must not be merged.

Important distinction 2: **performance vs contribution**

performance

how well someone performs.

contribution

what they add to the team's shared result.

In a group:

- > one person's performance may be excellent
- > but their contribution may be only one part of the final outcome.

Important distinction 3: **performance vs result**

performance

quality/process of how someone or something performs.

result

final outcome.

> strong performance but disappointing result

is completely possible.

For example, a team can play very well but still lose.

Important distinction 4: **performance vs productivity**

performance

broad overall quality/results.

productivity

amount of useful output relative to time/resources.

An employee's performance may include:

- * quality,
- * reliability,
- * teamwork,
- * productivity,
- * accuracy.

So performance is broader.

Important distinction 5: **performance vs efficiency**

performance

how well something works overall.

efficiency

how little resource is wasted.

A high-performance machine can be powerful but inefficient.

Important distinction 6: **performance vs achievement**

achievement

something successfully accomplished.

performance

how well someone carries out an activity.

> winning an award = achievement

> playing brilliantly = performance

Important distinction 7: **performance vs behaviour**

behaviour

how a person acts.

performance

how effectively they fulfil a task or role.

A polite employee may have good behaviour but poor job performance.

Important distinction 8: **performance work vs artistic performance**

Compare:

> employee performance

> 員工**工作表現**

> theatre performance

> 劇場**演出**

Same noun, genuinely different semantic branch.

Important distinction 9: **performance as technical “性能”**

When discussing machines:

> performance

does not mean the machine is “performing on stage.”

It means:

how effectively the machine operates

Translate naturally as:

> **性能 / 效能**

Important distinction 10: **perform a task vs do a task**

do a task

neutral everyday English.

perform a task

more formal/technical and emphasizes carrying out a function.

> The robot performs repetitive tasks.

sounds especially natural.

Important distinction 11: **perform vs carry out**

They overlap strongly.

perform

often used with:

- * task,
- * duty,
- * function,
- * operation,
- * experiment.

carry out

emphasizes executing something that has been arranged or instructed.

Important distinction 12: **perform = work/function**

A machine can:

> perform well

This means:

operate effectively

not:

> put on a show.

Important distinction 13: **performer = entertainer vs high performer**

Entertainment:

> stage performer

> 舞台表演者

Workplace:

> top performer

> 高績效員工

Context completely changes the Chinese translation.

Important distinction 14: **performance review vs performance appraisal**

These overlap heavily.

performance review

very common general workplace term.

performance appraisal

slightly more formal/HR-oriented.

Both mean:

工作表現評核

Important distinction 15: **performance-related pay**

This closely connects to the previous word **tie**:

> pay is tied to performance

> $\approx$

> performance-related pay

Both mean:

薪酬和績效掛鉤

Important distinction 16: **underperform vs fail**

underperform

do worse than expected or benchmark.

fail

do not achieve a required objective at all.

You can underperform and still technically succeed.

Important distinction 17: **outperform does not necessarily mean excellent**

If A performs poorly but B performs even worse:

> A outperformed B

can still be true.

It means **relative superiority**, not necessarily objectively high performance.

Important distinction 18: **performance in your passage**

Here **performance** is not merely:

> how hard someone tries.

It refers to the person's **actual work quality, effectiveness, and evaluated results**.

That is precisely why diligent employees dislike having their performance tied to less committed colleagues.

Family-extension note

Performance has several major modern branches:

1. **human work/academic performance**

- * employee performance

- * academic performance

2. **sports**

- * athletic performance

3. **artistic presentation**

- * live performance

- * give a performance

4. **execution of duties**

- * performance of duties

- * perform a task

5. **legal fulfilment**

- * performance of a contract

- * specific performance

6. **machine/system operation**

- * system performance
- * engine performance

7. **business/finance**

- * financial performance
- * market performance

8. **people by level**

- * top performer
- * high-performing team

9. **comparison with standards**

- * underperform
- * outperform

For your passage, the exact branch is:

performance = the quality and results of an employee's work

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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performance (work)	工作表現；績效	how well someone works
job performance	工作績效	employment
individual performance	個人表現	one person's results
team performance	團隊表現	group results
academic performance	學業表現	education
strong performance	出色表現	high level
poor performance	表現欠佳	low level
performance review	績效評核	workplace evaluation
performance appraisal	工作表現評估	formal HR
performance target	績效目標	benchmark
performance indicator	績效指標	measurement
performance-related pay	績效掛鉤薪酬	compensation
performance (sport)	競技表現	sport
performance (show)	演出；表演	arts
live performance	現場演出	arts
performance (acting)	演技；演出表現	performer quality
perform a task	執行任務	execution
performance of duties	履行職責	formal execution

performance (legal)	履行	contractual duty	
specific performance	強制履行	law	
performance (machine)	性能；效能	technical operation	
system performance	系統性能	computing	
engine performance	引擎性能	engineering	
high-performance	高性能的	high capability	
business performance	業務表現	organization	
financial performance	財務表現	finance	
perform well/badly	表現好 / 差	level	
performer	表演者	arts	
top performer	高績效者	workplace	
high-performing team	高績效團隊	organizational performance	
underperform	表現低於預期	below benchmark	
underperformance	表現欠佳	low performance	
outperform	表現勝過	exceed comparator	

For your original sentence

> When diligent workers realise that their ****performance**** is being tied to colleagues who are less committed, motivation begins to decline.

Here:

****performance = 勤奮員工本身的工作質素、效率、成果和正式評價****

The problem is that these outcomes may partly depend on colleagues who contribute less.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當勤奮的員工意識到自己的****工作表現 / 績效****竟然與投入程度較低的同事掛鉤時，他們的動力便開始下降。

The key contrast is:

> ****effort**** = 你投入多少心力

> ****contribution**** = 你為團隊實際加入多少價值

> ****performance**** = ****你最終做得有多好****

> ****result**** = 最後得到甚麼成果

That separation is especially important in this paragraph because ****high effort, individual contribution, personal performance, and shared group results are related—but they are not the same thing****.